

INSTITUTIONAL
INVESTOR



Private Credit Forum

May 14, 2025
Four Seasons Hotel
Chicago, IL

US Forums



The Goldilocks Era – Balancing Growth, Complexity, and Opportunity

Private credit is entering a transformative phase, with the global market expected to surpass \$1.6 trillion in assets under management in 2025. This growth is driven by its expanding role in M&A activity, where larger lenders are facilitating increasingly complex transactions. As private credit penetrates new asset classes and refines innovative deal structures, it offers investors enhanced opportunities to achieve stable, risk-adjusted returns. Regulatory shifts are also reshaping the landscape, promoting greater transparency and influencing market practices. Institutional interest in private credit is surging, with allocations projected to rise significantly as allocators seek diversification and protection against macroeconomic uncertainty.

Join us on **May 14, 2025**, at the **Four Season** in **Chicago** for our 4th Annual Private Credit Forum to examine these trends and addressing how private credit is navigating this pivotal “*Goldilocks era*” to balance growth, risk, and innovation.

Sponsoring Organizations

AEA Capital
AllianceBernstein
Apollo Global Management
Ardian
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Bain Capital
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Blue Owl
Centerbridge Partners
Crescent Capital
Crestline Investors
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Strategic Value Partners
Vista Equity Partners

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Agenda

Wednesday, May 14, 2025

8:00AM – 8:45AM**Event Registration and Breakfast**
Lakeview Foyer

8:45AM – 8:50AM**Introduction and App Tutorial**
Ballroom A & B**Presented By:**Naina Farukh, *Director – US Forums, Institutional Investor*

Everything an attendee needs to know about the **Private Credit Forum – Chicago** can be found on our meeting app. Review program details, speaker biographies, benchmarking survey results, attendee list, white papers, and access authorized speaker presentations at your convenience via this meeting app.

8:50AM – 9:00AM**Chairperson's Welcome & Benchmarking Survey**
Lakeview Junior Ballroom**Chairperson:**Thanos Papasavvas, CFA, *Founder & Chief Investment Officer, ABP Invest Ltd.*

What are the some of the primary concerns of your peers? Investment decision-makers from the larger pension plans, endowments, foundations, insurance entities will be polled on a number of high-interest topics using an anonymous, interactive electronic response system. In doing so, we aim to provide all attendees with useful benchmarks and unique insights into the concerns of institutional investors across the spectrum.

9:00AM – 9:40AM**Opening Panel: Charting the Future of Private Credit for 2025 and Beyond**
Strategic Investment Amidst Market Shifts
Lakeview Junior Ballroom

This session sets the stage by exploring the current state of private credit, characterized by significant growth, increasing complexity, evolving deal structures, and how the sector is positioned to navigate economic uncertainty. Discussions will focus on how to achieve an optimal balance between seizing opportunities and managing risks in this dynamic environment.

Moderator:Rahul Desai, Director, **Aksia LLC****Panelists:**Senior Representative, **Ardian**Senior Representative, **Centerbridge**Senior Representative, **Golub Capital**Russell Gannaway, *Managing Director, PIMCO*

9:40AM – 9:55AM**Fireside Chat: Staying Power: Navigating the Private Credit Shakeout**
Lakeview Junior Ballroom**Moderator: To be announced.**

Speaker: Senior Representative, **Bain Capital**

9:55AM –10:35AM

**Panel: Strategies for Direct Lenders to Thrive in 2025 and Beyond:
*Has the Golden Moment Passed?***

Lakeview Junior Ballroom

Despite the challenges facing the direct lending market, such as rising defaults and tighter lending conditions, opportunities still exist. It may not be the "golden moment", but direct lending is still a strong strategy. The key to success will be focusing on higher-quality loans and resilient market sectors to navigate economic uncertainty and maintain profitability.

Moderator: To be announced.

Panelists:

Senior Representative, **Crescent Capital**

Kevin Griffin, *Chief Executive Officer*, **MGG Investment Group**

Ted Denniston, Co-Head and Senior Managing Director, **NXT Capital**

Senior Representative, **Star Mountain Capital** (Proposed)

10:35AM–10:55AM

Tabletop Discussions

Lakeview Junior Ballroom

10:55AM–11:20AM

Coffee Break

Lakeview Foyer

11:20 AM–12:00 PM

Panel: The Surge in Asset-Based Finance: *How it's Powering Private Credit's Next Big Leap*

Lakeview Junior Ballroom

With private credit assets growing by nearly 10% annually, ABF has become an attractive asset class for investors seeking higher returns amidst uncertain market conditions and with global ABF market expected to expand from \$5.2 trillion to \$7.7 trillion by 2027. Panelists will discuss the factors driving this expansion, the opportunities it presents for investors, and the challenges that may arise in this rapidly evolving landscape. This discussion will focus on how technological advancements and the inclusion of new asset classes are reshaping asset-backed lending.

Moderator:

Gary Gipkhin, Director, **StepStone Group**

Panelists:

Robert Horn, *Sr. Managing Director*, **Blackstone**

Edwin Wilches, *Managing Director and Co-Head of Securitized Products*, **PGIM Fixed Income**

Loren Sageser, *Senior Product Strategist*, **Schroders**

12:00 PM–12:25 PM

**Think Tank: Navigating the Specialty Finance Landscape:
*The Niche Markets That Could Supercharge Your Portfolio***

Lakeview Junior Ballroom

As traditional financing becomes more restrictive, specialty finance offers investors unique opportunities to diversify and access high-yielding, non-correlated returns. The session will cover how it offers diversification and how it's evolving to meet new demands in sectors like healthcare, technology, transport, consumer finance and more!

Moderator: To be announced.

Panelists:

Jim McManus, Managing Director, Private Alternatives, **AB CarVal**
Peter Sterling, Managing Director, **Neuberger Berman**

12:25AM – 1:45PM

Lunch
Adorn

1:45PM–2:25PM

Structured for Success: NAV Lending, CLOs, and the Crossroads of Public and Private Credit
Lakeview Junior Ballroom

This session will explore the convergence of public and private credit markets, focusing on structured financing strategies like NAV lending and CLOs. These innovations are reshaping credit markets by driving liquidity, enhancing yield, and offering flexible solutions to manage capital in a changing environment. Discussions will highlight how these tools create opportunities for investors, address risk management challenges, and support growth amid evolving market conditions.

Moderator: To be announced.

Panelists:

Shobhit Gupta, Head of Multi-Credit Strategy, **Apollo Global**
David Philipp, *Partner, Fund Liquidity Solutions*, **Crestline Capital**
Jim Fitzpatrick, Chief Investment Officer, North America and Head of Global Loans, **Manulife CQS**
Himani Trivedi, Head of Structured Credit, **Nuveen**

2:25 PM – 2:55 PM

Think Tank: Private Credit's Diverging Paths: Scale Up or Seek Opportunity Elsewhere?
Lakeview Junior Ballroom

Moderator: To be announced.

Speaker:

Senior Representative, **Silverpoint**
Greg Galligan, Senior Managing Director, **Vista Credit Partners**

2:55 PM – 3:35 PM

Opportunistic and Distressed Investing: Navigating the Fine Line Between Risk and Reward
Lakeview Junior Ballroom

Moderator: To be announced.

Panelists:

Senior Representative, **AEA Investors**
Conor Bastable, Partner and Deputy Chief Investment Officer, **Davidson Kempner**
Ravi Mehta, Managing Director, **GCM Grosvenor**

3:35 PM – 3:45 PM

Tabletop Discussions
Lakeview Junior Ballroom

3:45 PM – 4:00 PM

Coffee Break
Lakeview Foyer

4:00 PM – 4:15 PM

Fireside Chat: Unlocking Liquidity and Opportunity

Lakeview Junior Ballroom

Moderator: To be announced.

Speaker: To be announced.

4:15 PM – 5:00 PM

Allocators’ Panel Discussion
Private Credit at a Crossroads: Adaptation, Innovation & Investor Strategy
Lakeview Junior Ballroom

As private credit approaches a \$2 trillion global market, institutional investors are adjusting to a rapidly evolving landscape. This panel will examine how investors are refining their strategies in response to key developments shaping the sector in 2025. Discussion will cover the growing **convergence between public and private markets** and its impact on portfolio diversification, the **rise of specialty finance** and niche credit strategies as avenues for higher yields and diversification, and the challenges posed by increasing **regulatory oversight**. Panelists will share insights on managing risks and capitalizing on emerging opportunities in the private credit space.

Moderator:
To be announced.

Panelists:
Julia Lee, AVP, Investments, **Horace Mann**
Brendon Reay, VP, Chief Investment Officer, **Maine Community Foundation**
Peggy Huang, Chief Investment Officer, **SiriusPoint**
Zhuoying (Joy) Xu, Senior Investment Director, **Verizon Investment Management Corp.**

5:00 PM

Networking Cocktail Reception
Delaware and Delaware Foyer

6:00 PM

Forum Concludes | Evening Free for Private Events
We look forward to seeing you on **September 18-19th** in **Toronto!**